

PMP CERTIFICATION CORE CONCEPTS

Certyfikat PMP: Project Information Management

From Quality Assurance to Effective Communication

dr Zbigniew Galar

The Project's Central Nervous System



The Architecture of Quality Assurance

Measuring organizational prganizational processes against defined standards.

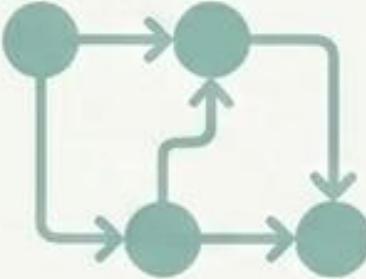
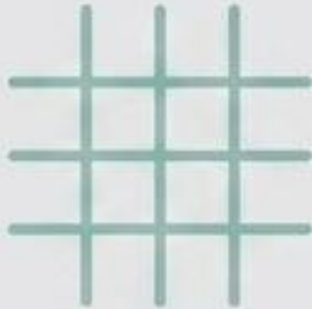


Perform Quality Assurance uses these processes to verify that the project satisfies the standards laid out in the planning phase.

Selecting the Right QA Tool: Mapping & Relationships

Tool Name	Visual Structure	Primary Use Case	PMP Example
Affinity Diagrams (KJ Methods)	 A diagram showing three central nodes connected to several peripheral nodes, representing the grouping of brainstormed ideas.	Grouping brainstormed ideas	Scope decomposition.
Process Decision Program Charts (PDPC)	 A hierarchical tree structure with a single root node branching into two intermediate nodes, which each further branch into two leaf nodes.	Contingency planning	Identifying impact results.
Interrelationship Digraphs	 A circular diagram with 10 nodes, each connected to multiple other nodes in a complex web, representing interdependent factors.	Complex problem solving	Relating up to 50 interdependent factors to find primary impacts.

Selecting the Right QA Tool: Hierarchies & Scheduling

Tool Name	Visual Structure	Primary Use Case	PMP Example
Tree Diagrams (Systematic)		Determining expected values	WBS (Work), RBS (Risk), OBS (Objectives).
Activity Network Diagrams		Formulating project schedules	AON (Activity on Node) diagrams.
Matrix Diagrams		Defining roles and relationships	RAMs, RACI charts (L-Type, T-Type, X-Type, C-Type).

Validating Processes: Audits & Analysis



The Event: Quality Audits

Independent reviews by trained specialists (internal or third-party).

Goals: Identify non-compliance, share best practices, and confirm defect repairs.

The Technique: Process Analysis

Examining problems and project constraints.

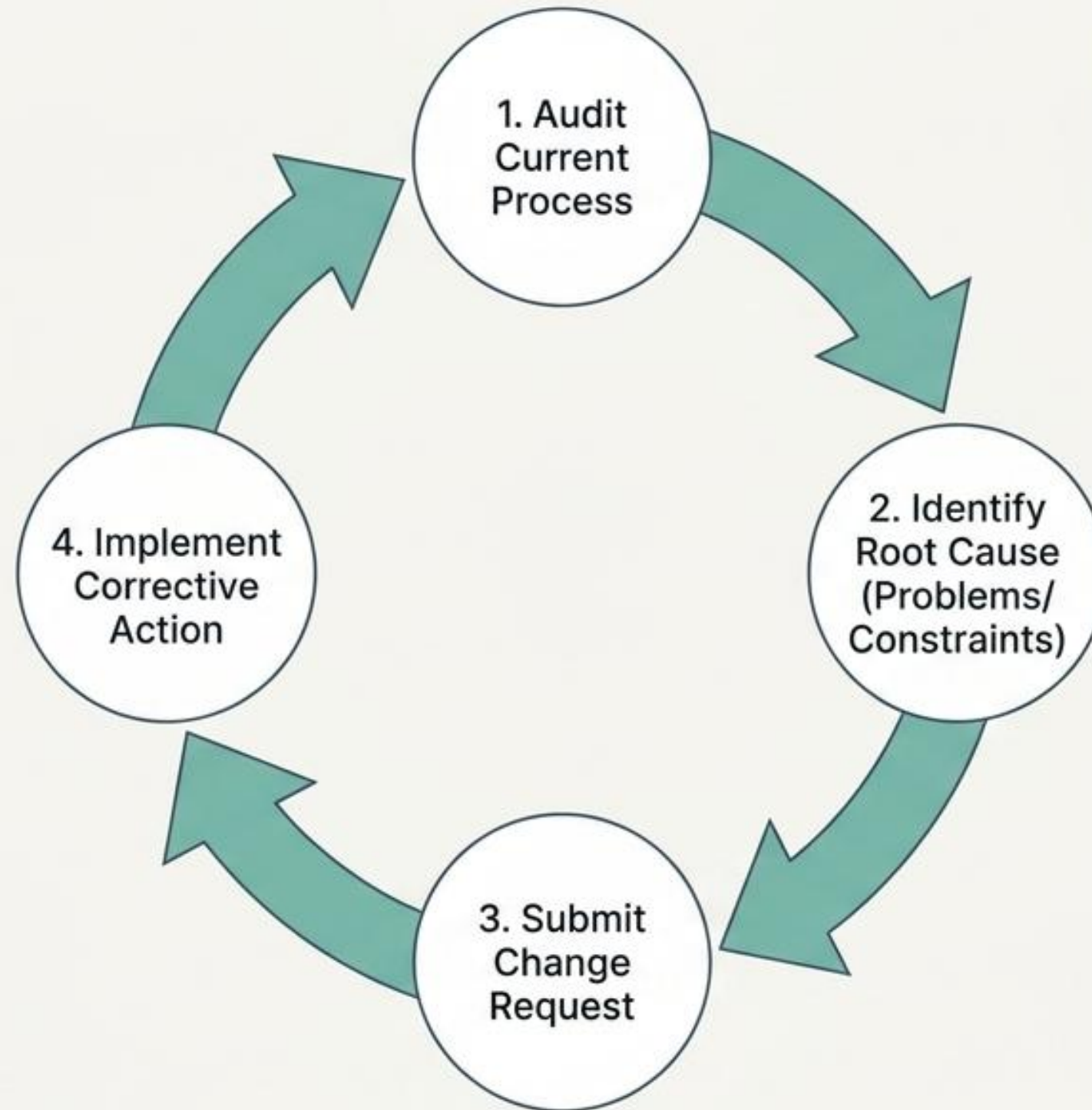
Core Method: Root Cause Analysis (understanding underlying issues rather than treating symptoms).

Process Improvement

Approved Change Requests & Corrective Actions to fix the process.

The Continuous Improvement Flywheel

The ultimate goal of Perform Quality Assurance is continuous, iterative improvement—drastically reducing the time a team spends on ineffective or inefficient activities.



Transitioning to Information Exchange

90%

The estimated percentage of time project managers spend communicating.

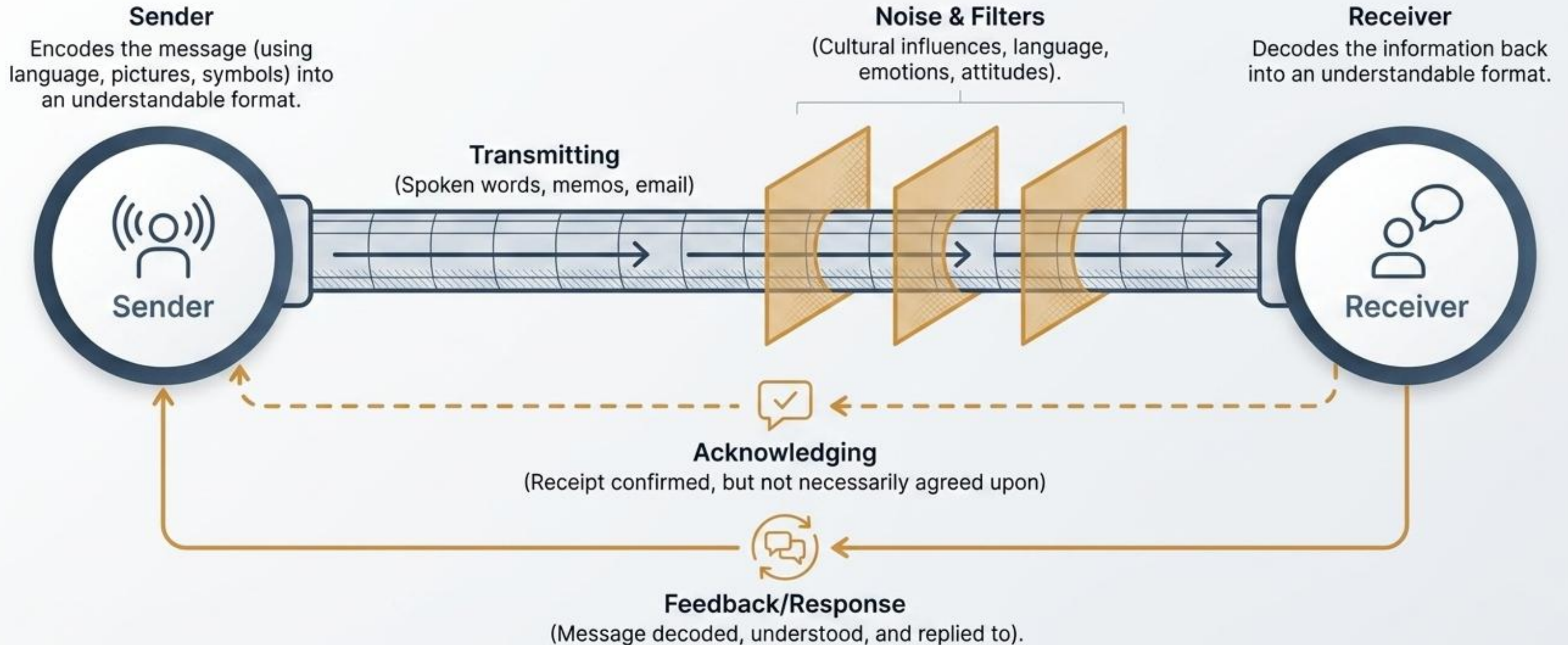
The Priority

Communication skills are arguably more important than technical skills for a PM.

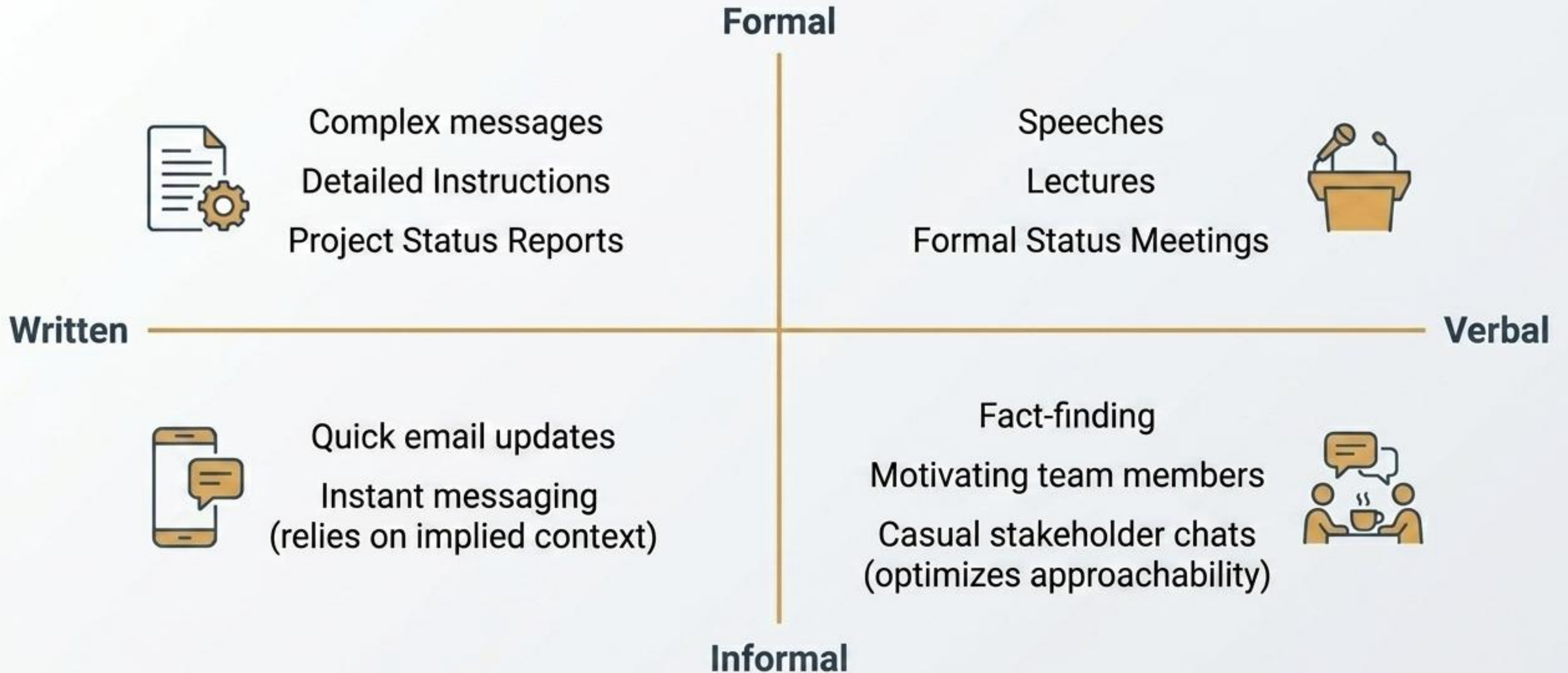
The Output

Excellent communication fosters the open, trusting environment required to execute the project plan.

The Mechanics of Communication Exchange



Selecting the Right Communication Format



Soft Skills as Information Safeguards

Active Listening Techniques



Maintain eye contact to demonstrate active interest.



Put speakers at ease prior to the meeting.



Recap and confirm: "Let me make sure I understand..."



Avoid interrupting (except to redirect a derailed meeting).

Conflict Resolution Strategies



Force / Direct



Smooth / Accommodate



Compromise / Reconcile



Collaborate / Problem Solve



Withdraw / Avoid

Decision Accuracy: Research shows decision accuracy peaks in group sizes of 5 to 11 participants.

Performance Reporting & Delivery Systems



Information Management Systems

The infrastructure for delivering data (PM software, collaborative work tools, portals, email).



Performance Reporting

Distributing the actual project status, including measurements on schedule progress, budget updates, and risk forecasts.



The Ultimate Output: Organizational Process Assets

